GUEST GUIDE · SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026

Linh & Huy

The wedding · *Lễ Vu Quy*

Sunday 25 October 2026
09:00

The bride's family home
550 Trần Hưng Đạo Street, Phủ Lý Ward, Ninh Bình

"Vu quy" literally means "the daughter goes to her husband's home". Held at the bride's family home, this ceremony marks the moment Linh says goodbye to her ancestors and her parents to start a family with Huy. The groom's family comes to "welcome the bride"; it is an emotional moment, followed by a big celebration meal.

ARRIVAL
9:00 am — the ceremony starts at 10:00 am

LENGTH
About 40 minutes of ceremony, then the reception from 10:40 am

DRESS
Dressy and colourful (an áo dài is very welcome). Avoid all-white, kept for the bride, and all-black

GIFT
An envelope (phong bì) with cash, or a bank transfer: see "The gift"

> ***The ancestral altar*** — In every Vietnamese home, the ancestral altar holds the place of honour. Before leaving her family, the bride announces her marriage there and thanks those who came before her: it is the spiritual heart of the day.

SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026

What happens

07:45 — Coach from Hanoi (if you booked a seat)

Meet at Keangnam (Phạm Hùng, Hanoi) to travel to Phủ Lý, about 1 h 15 by road.

YOUR PART Please be on time: the coach can't wait.

09:00 — Guests arrive

Guests are welcomed at Linh's parents' home with tea. There is usually a gift-envelope box near the entrance.

YOUR PART Greet the bride's parents, drop your envelope in the box if you have one, then take a seat.

The groom's family arrives

Huy's family arrives in procession, with a tray of betel and liquor, to ask to "welcome the bride". The two families' spokespeople exchange a few words.

YOUR PART Let the procession through and keep the entrance clear.

10:00 ● **Ceremony at the altar**

The couple lights incense and bows before the ancestral altar to announce their marriage and ask for a blessing.

YOUR PART Quiet and discreet: stay back from the altar.

● **Thanks and the parents' blessing**

The couple thanks Linh's parents, who share their advice for married life. Parents and relatives then give the bride gold jewellery, a gesture of protection and support.

YOUR PART The most moving moment — tears are common. Applaud when everyone applauds.

10:40 ● **Reception**

The celebration meal begins, often with a group toast. During the meal, the couple goes from table to table to drink with every guest.

YOUR PART Raise your glass with them: "Một, hai, ba, dzô!" You can also hand them your envelope then.

14:00 ● **Coach back to Hanoi**

Vietnamese receptions are short (about two hours) and it is normal to leave soon after the meal. The coach goes back from Phủ Lý to Keangnam.

YOUR PART Before you go, say goodbye to the couple's parents: "Cảm ơn!"

The gift

- The tradition is to give money in an envelope (phong bì) with your name written on it.
- Drop it in the box at the entrance, or hand it to the couple with both hands when they visit your table.
- You can also use the PayPal or Vietcombank QR codes on the wedding website.

At the table

- Dishes are shared in the middle of the table: use the serving chopsticks if there are some.
- Wait for the elders to start, or to be invited to eat ("Mời!").
- Never stand your chopsticks upright in your rice: that gesture belongs to funeral rites.
- Toasts are frequent, often with beer: toasting with a soft drink is perfectly fine.

Good to know

- Give and receive things (envelope, cup, glass) with both hands.
- Greet the elders first.
- You may be asked to take your shoes off inside the house: wear shoes that slip off easily.
- Photos are welcome, but never in front of the altar during the rites.

Weather & practical

- Late October in Ninh Bình: around 22–29 °C, humid, showers possible. Bring a light jacket and an umbrella.
- Keep some cash in Vietnamese dong (VND) on you.

A few words

Rough pronunciation in brackets — any effort will be warmly appreciated!

Xin chào	*(sin chow)*	Hello
Cảm ơn	*(gahm uhn)*	Thank you
Chúc mừng!	*(chook mung)*	Congratulations!
Trăm năm hạnh phúc	*(chum num hahn fook)*	“A hundred years of happiness” — the classic wish to newlyweds
Một, hai, ba, dzô!	*(mote, hi, ba, yo)*	“One, two, three, cheers!” — the toast
Ngon quá!	*(ngon kwah)*	Delicious!
Cô dâu · Chú rể	*(koh yoh · choo zeh)*	The bride · the groom
Nhà trai · Nhà gái	*(nyah chai · nyah guy)*	Groom’s family · bride’s family

Trăm năm hạnh phúc